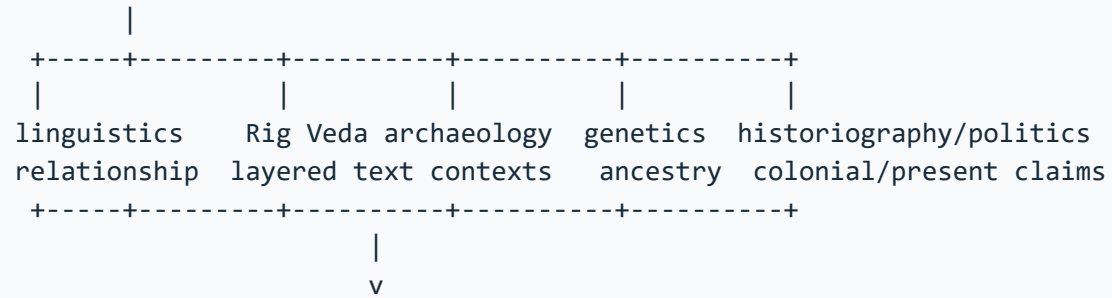


ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Category firewall: language is not race

TERM	VALID USE	INVALID COLLAPSE
arya	self/cultural designation	biological race
Indo-Aryan	branch of Indo-Iranian languages	skull type or pure people
Indo-Iranian	linguistic-cultural relationship	one archaeological culture
Aryan culture	reconstructed practices/texts	uniform invading nation
	v	
Separate language, ancestry, material culture and identity before comparison.		

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Why the Aryan problem persists

QUESTION: how did Indo-Aryan speech and early Vedic culture form in South Asia?

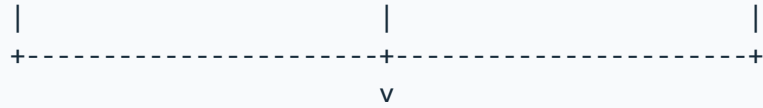


No class alone identifies a group, route, date and cultural outcome.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Working chronology and interaction corridor

SINTASHTA/STEPPE -> CENTRAL ASIAN/BMAC CONTACT -> NORTH-WEST SOUTH ASIA -> VEDIC MILIEU

2nd millennium BCE technology/speech hypotheses -> interaction -> cultural synthesis



Mitanni Indo-Aryan names and terms provide external attestation in western Asia.

A corridor model is not a mapped army route; scale and social process stay open.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Linguistic evidence: descent plus contact

regular sound correspondences + shared vocabulary + grammar

|

v

Indo-European family -> Indo-Iranian branch -> Indo-Aryan differentiation

|

+-----+-----+

|

inherited vocabulary

|

loanwords and retroflexion from contact

+-----+-----+

v

Language transmission cannot alone specify genes, route or invasion.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Rigvedic identity: a cultural system

RIG VEDA: layered oral corpus in a north-western Sapta-Sindhu milieu

- |-- economy: cattle-centred pastoralism with agriculture and crafts
- |-- polity: jana, vis, rajan, sabha, samiti; no territorial empire
- |-- society: kinship/difference; later caste must not be projected backward
- |-- religion: deities, rita, yajna, soma and praise-poetry
- |-- warfare: horse/chariot terms and cattle/route conflicts

+> identity is cultural-historical, not a racial phenotype.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Archaeological cultures are not peoples

Cemetery H	Gandhara Grave/Swat	OCP/Copper Hoards	PGW
Punjab mortuary	frontier burials and	upper Ganga material	later plain horizon
change/continuity	interaction	associations vary	settlement pattern
+-----+-----+-----+			
v			

None equals Aryan people by itself; relate dates, regions and practices cautiously.
Sanauli vehicles cannot settle horse-chariot identity without technical context.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Archaeogenetics: result and claim boundary

ANCIENT SAMPLE -> contamination control -> genetic components -> statistical model

|

v

Rakhigarhi: one Harappan-context genome; not the whole civilisation.

South/Central Asian aDNA models: later Steppe-related ancestry entered South Asia.

|

v

Ancestry can show mixture/timing ranges, not language or self-identity alone.

Sampling is sparse, uneven and vulnerable to political overclaim.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Competing models and best-fit verdict

INVASION: rapid violent replacement -> simplistic and archaeologically weak

IN-MIGRATION: movement over time + interaction -> better multi-source fit

INDIGENOUS/OIT: local formation/outward movement -> must explain linguistic geography,
Mitanni evidence and ancient-DNA patterns

SYNTHESIS: mobility + continuity + borrowing + intermarriage + cultural recomposition

|

v

VERDICT: migration is not conquest; continuity is not isolation; evidence is graded.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Aryan-problem answer architecture

10 MARKS: define categories -> two evidence classes -> one limit -> cautious verdict

15 MARKS: historiography -> linguistic case -> text/archaeology -> genetics -> synthesis

20 MARKS: firewall -> evidence matrix -> corridor -> competing models

-> Harappan continuity/contact -> political misuse -> graded conclusion

EVIDENCE VERB: supports / is consistent with / complicates; avoid proves when indirect.

CLOSE: early Vedic culture formed through mobility and South Asian interaction, not race.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Evidence ladder and confidence control

EVIDENCE LADDER

1. Keep language, genes, pottery, ethnicity, civilisation and polity separate.
2. Compare linguistic, textual, archaeological and genetic chronologies.
3. State sample, route, scale and social-mechanism uncertainty for every model.

VERDICT: Secure relationships do not make every historical mechanism settled.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Examiner traps and contested boundaries

CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

1. Migration is not invasion; continuity does not prove absence of movement.
2. PGW, BMAC, Swat, OCP and Sinauli do not automatically identify language.
3. Steppe-related ancestry is biological evidence, not a Vedic-language label.

VERDICT: Reject racial and civilisational certainty from every side of the debate.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Integrated answer spine and qualified conclusion

ANSWER SPINE

1. Record zero direct origin/migration PYQs; keep adjacent Vedic questions cross-owned.
2. Define terms -> weigh evidence -> compare invasion, migration and indigenous models.
3. End with interaction, admixture, acculturation and unresolved route/scale questions.

VERDICT: A balanced inference is evidence-led, category-safe and politically non-presentist.